Joonho Lee

Director, Neuromeka AI Lab

On military duty (until 2027.4.30., Technical Research Personnel)

Robotics researcher and hands-on systems engineer, combining robot learning research with end-to-end development and real-world deployment. PhD from ETH Zurich's Robotic Systems Lab, with a focus on legged robotics; now leading AI research for industrial robots at Neuromeka.

joonho.lee@neuromeka.com · Google Scholar

Experience

2024 – now	**Neuromeka Co., Ltd.** Director, AI Group · Military service
2022 – 2024	**RIVR** Conceived and developed the initial RL-based control and navigation stack

Education

2018 – 2024	**ETH Zurich, Robotic Systems Lab** PhD, Mechanical Engineering Thesis: Advancing the Autonomy of Legged Robots: From the Lab to the Real-world · Supervisor: Marco Hutter · Co-examiners: Vladlen Koltun, Sehoon Ha
2017 – 2018	**ETH Zurich** MSc Robotics, Systems and Control · Rank 1/76
2012 – 2016	**POSTECH** BSc Mechanical Engineering · Rank 2/17

Funding

2024 – 2029	**Development of AI-based medical and care humanoid robot** International Joint R&D Program, KIAT, Ministry of Trade, Industry and Energy Planned the project and lead its execution Partners: Georgia Tech (Sehoon Ha et al.), ETRI, KAIST ≈ US$7M (KRW 10B) over 5 years

Selected publications

2026	**Accurate pouring-based powder dispensing via world models** Seungmin Son, Dongwoo Ko, Young Jin Heo, Wan Kyun Chung, Joonho Lee Submitted to IEEE T-RL
2026	**Learning reflexive behavior for contact-rich manipulation** Quan Nguyen, Yunho Kim, Joonho Lee Submitted to ICRA 2027
2026	**Learning-augmented robotic automation for real-world manufacturing** Yunho Kim, Quan Nguyen, Taewhan Kim, Youngjin Heo, Joonho Lee Nature Communications, accepted · arXiv:2604.22235
2025	**Learning fast, tool-aware collision avoidance for collaborative robots** Joonho Lee, Yunho Kim, Seokjoon Kim, Quan Nguyen, Youngjin Heo IEEE RA-L
2025	**Learning-based legged locomotion: State of the art and future perspectives** Sehoon Ha, Joonho Lee, Michiel van de Panne, Zhaoming Xie, Wenhao Yu, Majid Khadiv IJRR 44(8)

2024 **Learning to walk in confined spaces using 3D representation**
Takahiro Miki, Joonho Lee, Lorenz Wellhausen, Marco Hutter
ICRA · Best Paper Award in Service Robotics

2024 **Learning robust autonomous navigation and locomotion for wheeled-legged robots**
Joonho Lee, Marko Bjelonic, Alexander Reske, Lorenz Wellhausen, Takahiro Miki, Marco Hutter
Science Robotics 9(89)

2024 **When monkeys meet an ANYmal robot in the wild**
Charlotte Canteloup, Joonho Lee, Samuel Zimmermann, Morgane Alvino, Markus Montenegro, Marco Hutter, Erica van de Waal
bioRxiv 2024.08.13.607714

2022 **Learning robust perceptive locomotion for quadrupedal robots in the wild**
Takahiro Miki, Joonho Lee, Jemin Hwangbo, Lorenz Wellhausen, Vladlen Koltun, Marco Hutter
Science Robotics 7(62)

2022 **CERBERUS: Autonomous legged and aerial robotic exploration in the tunnel and urban circuits of the DARPA Subterranean Challenge**
Marco Tranzatto, Frank Mascarich, Lukas Bernreiter, ... Joonho Lee, ... Marco Hutter, Roland Siegwart, Mark Mueller, Maurice Fallon, Kostas Alexis
Field Robotics 2

2020 **Learning quadrupedal locomotion over challenging terrain**
Joonho Lee, Jemin Hwangbo, Lorenz Wellhausen, Vladlen Koltun, Marco Hutter
Science Robotics 5(47) · IEEE RAS TC-MBOR Best Paper Award · Cover article

2019 **Learning agile and dynamic motor skills for legged robots**
Jemin Hwangbo, Joonho Lee, Alexey Dosovitskiy, Dario Bellicoso, Vassilios Tsounis, Vladlen Koltun, Marco Hutter
Science Robotics 4(26)

Awards

2025 **ETH Zurich Medal for outstanding doctoral thesis**
ETH Zurich

2024 **Best Paper Award in Service Robotics**
IEEE ICRA

2020 **Best Paper Award, TC on Model-Based Optimization for Robotics**
IEEE Robotics & Automation Society

2019 **ETH Zurich Medal for outstanding master's thesis**
ETH Zurich

2019 **Willi Studer Prize (Best Graduate), Robotics, Systems and Control**
D-MAVT, ETH Zurich

Service & teaching

2025 – 2026 **Area Chair**
Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)

2026 – now **Associate Editor**
IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L)

2025 **Workshop organizer: The Future of Hybrid Mobility**
IEEE/RSJ IROS 2025

2019 – 2023 **Teaching assistant, Robot Dynamics**
ETH Zurich

Invited talks & lectures

22 TALKS

2026.09.22	**From Paper to Factory Floor: Building Smart Robots for Industry** — ME Seminar, KAIST (KR)
2025.11.28	**Teaching Robots to Walk and Work** — CSE/GSAI Seminar, POSTECH (KR)
2025.06.04	**Training Robots to Move and Work** — IRIM Seminar, Georgia Institute of Technology (US)
2025.02.10	**Elevating Robotic Performance through Learned Autonomy** — ME Seminar, SNU (KR)
2024.10.15	**Advancing the Autonomy of Legged Robots** — KAIST AI (KR)
2024.01.02	**Learning locomotion and autonomous navigation for legged robots** — SUSTech (CN)
2023.12.29	**Learning locomotion and autonomous navigation for legged robots** — Zhejiang University (CN)
2023.08.02	**Navigating real-world with legged robots** — Georgia Institute of Technology (US)
2022.11.10	**Robust quadrupedal locomotion via RL** — Krafton (KR)
2022.11.08	**Toward the real-world applications of autonomous walking robots** — POSTECH (KR)
2022.11.03	**Developing legged robots for outdoor use** — Agency for Defense Development (ADD) (KR)
2022.04.25	**RL for quadrupedal locomotion** — DLR (DE)
2022.01.12	**Learning quadrupedal locomotion over challenging terrain** — RILAB, Korea University (KR)
2021.07.12	**Learning quadrupedal locomotion over challenging terrain** — CRL, ETH Zurich (CH)
2021.07.02	**Learning quadrupedal locomotion over challenging terrain** — Telluride Neuromorphic Cognition Engineering Workshop (US)
2021.05.21	**Learning quadrupedal locomotion over challenging terrain** [video] — NCCR Robotics Seminar (CH)
2021.02.26	**Learning quadrupedal locomotion over challenging terrain** [video] — PAIR, University of Toronto (CA)
2021.02.12	**인공지능기술을 활용한 4족보행로봇 제어** — AI Winter School, Korean Society of Mechanical Engineers (KSME) (KR)
2020.11.10	**Learning quadrupedal locomotion over challenging terrain** — CSIRO (AU)
2020.08.05	**Learning legged locomotion – walking through a forest** — Intel Labs (US)
2019.02.13	**시뮬레이션에서의 심층강화학습을 이용한 보행로봇 제어** — Korea Institute of Industrial Technology (KR)
2019.02.11	**시뮬레이션에서의 심층강화학습을 이용한 보행로봇 제어** — Agency for Defense Development (ADD) (KR)